



Mostly sunny 86/70 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 87/71 **B20**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

TUESDAY, JULY 22, 2025 • \$4

Hamas sees its revenue dry up

Group unable to pay its fighters, replace tunnels and command centers

BY SHIRA RUBIN
AND HAZEM BALOUSHA

TEL AVIV — Hamas is facing its worst financial and administrative crisis in its four-decade history, confronting stiff challenges in mustering the resources it would need to continue to fight Israel and rule Gaza.

With its coffers depleted, Hamas's military wing can no longer adequately pay the salaries of its fighters, though it is still able to recruit teenage boys for missions like keeping a lookout as explosives are placed along Israeli military routes, according to Oded Ailam, a former high-level Israeli intelligence officer, and current Israel Defense Forces officers.

The group has also been unable to replace the well-equipped tunnels and underground command centers that Israeli forces have destroyed in their bid to uproot Hamas.

Before being killed in an airstrike two months ago, Hamas military commander Mohammed Sinwar had taken refuge in a one-room hideout 30 feet below a hospital in southern Gaza. The spartan bunker was a far cry from the vast underground complex that the Israeli military said it found earlier in the war farther north, which included spacious white-tiled rooms, a blastproof door, mechanical ventilation and ample

SEE HAMAS ON A13

U.N. in Gaza: The WHO said Israeli troops raided its guesthouse. **A16**

Behind Gaza aid provider are for-profit U.S. interests

BY KAREN DEYOUNG
AND CATE BROWN

Inside the four hastily constructed warehouses in southern Gaza where food is handed out to desperate and starving Palestinians, it is relatively calm. Ration boxes stamped with the name and logo of the Gaza Humanitarian Foundation are distributed by local volunteers in red vests, under the watchful gaze of beefy, armed American security contractors.

It is just outside the warehouses where most of the trouble happens. Outside is where hundreds of civilians desperately crowding toward the distribution sites have been shot and killed — many of them allegedly by Israeli soldiers positioned nearby — and where at least 20 Palestinians died Wednesday in a stampede that the GHF says was initiated by gun-toting Hamas militants.

Humanitarian aid has been one of the most controversial aspects of the war between Israel and Hamas, which is now approaching its second anniversary. In recent weeks, it has emerged as a final sticking point in negotiations over a ceasefire, placing the Israeli- and U.S.-backed GHF squarely in the crosshairs of the latest talks.

Hamas is demanding a return to the U.N.-coordinated system of

SEE GAZA ON A12

Fighter jet crashes into school in Bangladesh



REUTERS

A crew works to remove wreckage after a Bangladeshi air force jet on a training mission crashed into a campus for prekindergarten through high school in Dhaka. At least 20 people were killed and over 160 injured. **Story, A9**

Grocery store's bare shelves show limits of city-led model

BY ANNIE GOWEN

KANSAS CITY, MO. — It was the lone tomato in the produce bin that nearly made Marquita Taylor weep.

She'd stopped in her neighborhood grocery store, the place that was cause for celebration when it opened seven years ago. Area residents had long lived without a decent supermarket on Kansas City's east side, and KC Sun Fresh was the city's attempt to alleviate a lack of access to healthy food in its urban center.

But the store, in a city-owned strip mall, is on the verge of closure. Customers say they are increasingly afraid to shop there — even with visible police patrols — because of drug dealing, theft and vagrancy inside and outside the store and the public library

across the street.

KC Sun Fresh lost \$885,000 last year and now has only about 4,000 shoppers a week. That's down from 14,000 a few years ago, according to Emmet Pierson Jr., who leads Community Builders of Kansas City, the nonprofit group that leases the site from the city. Despite a recent \$750,000 cash infusion from the city, the shelves are almost bare.

"We're in a dire situation," Pierson said.

As grocery prices continue to climb and 7 million Americans face losing federal food assistance, more cities and states across the country — in Illinois, Georgia and Wisconsin — are experimenting with the concept of publicly supported grocery stores as a way to help provide for

SEE GROCERY STORE ON A20

Trump's Commanders threat 'just noise,' D.C. leaders say

BY MEAGAN FLYNN,
JENNY GATHRIGHT
AND DANA HEDGPETH

For years, D.C. Mayor Muriel E. Bowser has sought to return the Washington Commanders to the District. The Democrat worked with a Kentucky Republican to get control of the RFK Stadium land through Congress, with a surprise unanimous vote in the Senate in the 11th hour. She brokered a \$3.7 billion deal with Commanders owner Josh Harris, representing the largest private investment in a single project in city history.

But with final passage of the deal by the D.C. Council potentially only weeks away, the mayor now faces the kind of wrench that's become all too familiar this year: President Donald Trump injecting himself into a local D.C.

matter where he has no formal role.

Trump, in a social media post over the weekend, called on the Commanders to "immediately" change the team name back to the Redskins, a dictionary-defined racial slur against Native Americans that the team dropped in 2020, and said he "may put a restriction" on the stadium deal if ownership does not comply.

Bowser brushed aside the threat, saying she wanted to stay focused on the D.C. government's role in the deal.

"I have worked for the better part of 10 years to get our part completed, including getting control of the land, coming to an

SEE COMMANDERS ON A8

Barry Svrluga: The name should be left to the team's owners. **B7**

Websites aim to thwart ICE, but some see risks to agents

BY ROBERT KLEMKO

Two decades ago, Sherman Austin decided the life of an internet activist was no longer worth the trouble. He'd landed in federal prison at 20 years old after investigators found instructions on how to make a bomb on a website he hosted. After a year behind bars, Austin retired his self-taught coding skills. He found work as a low-voltage electrician in Long Beach, California, trained in mixed martial arts and started a family.

Then President Donald Trump's mass deportation campaign roiled the Los Angeles region. Austin thought of his high-school-age children and the prospect of masked, anonymous federal officers entering their school to make arrests. The community would need to be alerted if that happened, he thought, so undocumented people could escape and less-vulnerable people might show up and protest.

After several late-night coding marathons, Austin launched

StopICE.net, which invites people to report sightings of suspected federal officers and notifies users who sign up for alerts. The network now boasts more than 470,000 subscribers nationwide. It is one of dozens of sites that have launched in recent months as undocumented immigrants and many U.S. citizens grow alarmed at the scale of Trump's deportation effort and the aggressive tactics officers are using to detain people.

Government officials including Attorney General Pam Bondi contend that the websites are endangering the lives of officers and their families and effectively mobilizing communities to attack officers at work.

The Department of Homeland Security says Immigration and Customs Enforcement officers are

SEE ICE ON A7

L.A. deployment: 700 Marines will withdraw from the city. **A5**

Masked agents: ICE chief stands by use of coverings during raids. **A6**

IN THE NEWS

Senate race in Texas State Attorney General Ken Paxton's impending divorce and his wife's allegations of adultery have jolted the Republican Party's primary contest. **A4**

School safety The D.C. inspector general found "critical gaps" in the approach to gun violence prevention on city campuses. **B13**

THE NATION
A former police officer got 33 months in prison in connection with Breonna Taylor's slaying. **A2**
The administration released thousands of files on Martin Luther King Jr.'s assassination. **A8**

THE WORLD
Tariffs are poised to up-end trade with the E.U. See what industries would be hit hardest. **A14**
A notorious Ecuadorian drug lord was extradited to the U.S. and pleaded not guilty. **A14**

THE ECONOMY
Starlink internet service is great for some users, but it has a significant drawback, Shira Ovide writes. **A15**

STYLE
Social media has brought success to influencers with Down syndrome, but there are AI-related concerns. **B1**

OBITUARIES
Malcolm-Jamal Warner, the actor and musician best known for his role on "The Cosby Show," was 54. **B1**

SPORTS
The NFLPA's election of Lloyd Howell as its executive director two years ago was troubled from the very start. **B11**

THE REGION
Bob Weir, the supervisor of the Gainesville District in Prince William County since 2023, died of cancer at 62. **B13**
The Montgomery County Council is set to vote on a proposal that would enable multi-unit housing to be built in more areas. **B13**

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The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54285

